

Fat-tailed dwarf lemur

Cheirogaleus medius

- ↔ 7–10 in (17–26 cm)
- 📍 W. and S. Madagascar
- ⊗ Locally common

No bigger than a squirrel, the fat-tailed dwarf lemur, or the lesser dwarf lemur, is one of the smallest primates, with big, dark-ringed eyes for locating food in the forest at night. During the tropical rainy

season, it searches trees and shrubs for fruit, flowers, and insects, building up a reserve of fat in its tail. This sustains it through the eight-month dry season, when it enters a state of dormancy similar to hibernation.



Betsileo sportive lemur

Lepilemur betsileo

- ↔ 10 in (26 cm)
- 📍 E. Madagascar
- ⊗ Endangered

The sportive lemurs owe their name to the athletic habit of using their hindlimbs to leap from one tree trunk to another. Named after the Malagasy Betsileo people, this species lives in the humid rainforests of eastern Madagascar, feeding mainly on leaves and flowers. Gray-brown with a black tail, the sportive lemur is solitary while awake but gathers in groups to sleep.

Black lemur

Eulemur macaco

- ↔ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)
- 📍 N. Madagascar
- ⊗ Vulnerable

Like many lemurs, this species is found only in Madagascar. The males are black, while the females are red, brown, or gray; however, both sexes have a distinctive pale ruff around the neck and shoulders. Groups of up to 15 individuals forage together in trees for fruit, as well as leaves and flowers, gathering them with their hands. They often feed at

night, which is unusual for lemurs and possibly a response to human disturbance. Lemurs are also hunted for food.



Monk saki

Pithecia monachus

- ↔ 15–19 in (38–48 cm)
- 📍 N. and W. South America
- ⊗ Locally common

The Monk saki is covered in long, coarse, black fur that falls around its face like a monk's hood. It has a thick, bushy tail which, unlike that of many New World monkeys, is not prehensile. Despite this, it spends most of its time on treetops, staying high in the canopy and keeping very quiet, although it can make a loud alarm call if threatened by a high-flying predator.

Bald uakari

Cacajao calvus

- ↔ 15–23 in (38–57 cm)
- 📍 NW. South America
- ⊗ Vulnerable

Instantly identifiable by its bright red face and bald crown, which contrast with its shaggy red-brown or white fur, the bald uakari lives in seasonally flooded forests bordering rivers and swamps in the west of the Amazon basin. It forages by day in mixed-sex troops of 10 to 20, but sometimes up to 100, searching the trees for seeds, fruit, flowers, and insects.

Southern muriqui

Brachyteles arachnoides

- ↔ 22–24 in (55–61 cm)
- 📍 C. South America (SE. Brazil)
- ⊗ Endangered

Also known as woolly spider monkeys, the two species of muriquis live only in the Atlantic coastal forests of Brazil near São Paulo, where both are now endangered by habitat destruction. Locally known as the charcoal monkey because of its black face, the brown-furred southern muriqui has a heavy body, long limbs, and hooklike fingers with no external thumb. Its prehensile tail helps it to climb through the trees as it feeds on fruit, seeds, and tender leaves.

Guatemalan black howler

Alouatta pigra

- ↔ 21–25 in (53–64 cm)
- 📍 Mexico, Central America
- ⊗ Endangered

This is the biggest of the howler monkeys—a group of New World monkeys famous for the phenomenal volume of the males' territorial whoops and howls. Twice the weight of the female, each male controls a troop of about seven females and juveniles, and calls at dawn and dusk to warn off neighboring troops. Howler monkeys feed mainly on leaves, but also take ripe fruit.

Gray woolly monkey

Lagothrix cana

- ↔ 20–26 in (50–65 cm)
- 📍 C. South America
- ⊗ Endangered

Named for their thick, close-curved fur, woolly monkeys live in the tropical forests of South America, where they feed mainly on fruit in the treetops. The gray woolly monkey's fur is gray with black flecks, with a darker head, hands, feet, and tail tip. It is an agile climber, with powerful shoulders and hips, and a prehensile tail capable of supporting its weight from a branch while it gathers food. It lives in mixed troops, with a hierarchy based on age.

